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SM2 7EH

The Planning Department
London Borough of Sutton
Civic Offices, St Nicolas Way
Sutton. SM1 1EA

22 February 2026

Dear Planning Department

Re: DM2025/01591

I write in support of the above planning application.

I visited the site of the former ambulance station at the open day for local residents. I asked a number of questions regarding the development. The organisers were very open about the plans (which were on a board) and the layout and proposed usage.

I came away with a strong sense of community support for the project. Local people have made significant financial contributions to the purchase of the site. I can think of very few *better uses for the site then a community centre which will provide a space for prayer and meditation, advice on health and well-being, sports and a multiuse community space.* The older residents in the local area who attended were pleased to hear that they would be able to drop in for a chat and a cup of tea. The value of this cannot be overstated in an age when loneliness particularly amongst the elderly is a real issue.

The dedicated women's space which I was shown, is a good size. It will enable women to have a private area which is safe and comfortable.

It is my understanding that Friday prayer times will be staggered to avoid the busy pickup and drop-off times for the local school.

The site has a large frontage with a number of parking spaces and bike racks. Most people attending the centre for prayers on Fridays will be strongly encouraged to use public transport or walk. Parking marshals will ensure that there are no parking issues. I consider that strenuous efforts have been made by the organisers to deal with the issue of traffic management in a comprehensive way taking into account any local concerns.

As an operational ambulance station, ambulances were going in and out in a 24-hour facility. This level of disturbance only ceased when the ambulance centre closed down.

The community hub will have restricted hours. There will be no question of any noise pollution.

The design of the development is modest. It works well with the existing character of the street scene. The grass and plants at the front can be further landscaped. The parking is along the side and at the back. The site appears low-key and integrated into the existing street scene.

I consider that the proposal provides an inclusive community orientated facility with a focus on local needs. There are many families with young children who will undoubtedly appreciate the inclusion of a creche and a children's programme.

In recent years youth focused spaces have closed almost entirely in some boroughs. This centre will address the gap in local services by providing a safe and constructive environment for young people to meet and seek advice on a variety of different issues.

I have no doubt that the community centre offers a wonderful opportunity to support local amenities and to provide a much-valued space for local people in the area.

Many residents will read with anxious scrutiny the decision that Sutton Council makes in this planning application which so many people support.

Yours Faithfully,

A solid black rectangular box used to redact the signature of Mrs Shazadi Mian.

Mrs Shazadi Mian